

Performance Notes

General observations

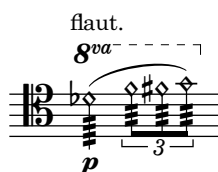
Forte markings in quotation marks (e.g. “*ff*”) indicate the subjective intensity of the physical effort required, not the resulting sound level. The effort itself must remain perceptible.

Diamond noteheads at quarter-note values are semi-blackened to distinguish them from half-note values.

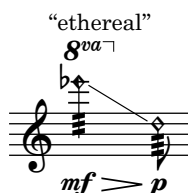
Violoncello



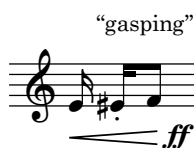
In addition to the standard clefs (treble, tenor, and bass), the string clef appears in this score. The string clef indicates the string on which the action is to be performed. It appears exclusively in passages behind the bridge, typically combined with pressed bowing or plucking.



Bowing near or over the fingerboard with minimal pressure, producing a veiled, non-vibrato tone in which bow friction predominates over pitch.



Flautato glissando on the lowest possible string, aiming for a high, echo-like tone. Place a second finger between the stopping finger and the nut to avoid unwanted harmonic effects.



The player abruptly interrupts an explosive crescendo in up-bow by releasing pressure on the string and ripping the bow away at the last moment. The resulting sound resembles a reversed pizzicato.



The mute symbol indicates that all four strings are lightly dampened by placing the left hand flat on their surface.



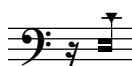
Lightly touch the string at the nodal point without depressing it. Notehead indicates the touch point; the resulting pitch depends on the partial produced.



Bounced with the center of the bow wood on muted strings. Pitches are notated as small blank squares and indicate where the bow contacts the string; they result from the wood striking the string at that position, not from left-hand fingering (the left hand is used only for muting). Pitches are approximate.



The springing bow is pressed forcefully against the string to produce a dense, extended trill effect. If glissando is indicated, the contact point shifts toward the bridge (upward) or fingerboard (downward).



Plucked note (pizzicato).



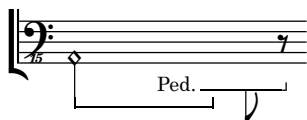
Pizzicato with the left hand.

Piano

A concert grand piano is required; the lid must be raised throughout. A non-metallic beater is also required for actions on the tuning pins.



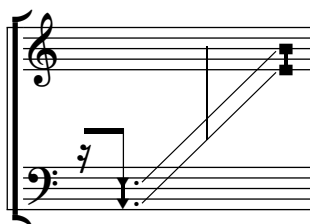
The standard two staves are supplemented by an additional staff above and below. Notes on the upper staff sound two octaves higher than written (15ma); notes on the lower staff sound two octaves lower (15mb).



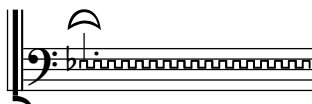
Sustain pedal indications are placed slightly higher than sostenuto pedal indications. For the sostenuto pedal, the notes to be sustained are indicated by a vertical line connecting them to the pedal marking.



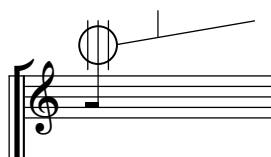
Diamond noteheads indicate keys to be depressed silently and held, either by hand or with the sostenuto pedal.



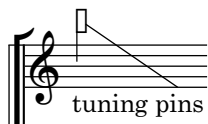
Cluster glissandi on strings: execute with fingertips placed next to each other, or with the flat of the hand.



Strings rubbed with the fingernail are notated as crenellated lines and with $\frown$. The fingernail should be loosely pressed against the string winding and moved along it according to the indicated dynamic. The resulting sound is a “radiant” rattle.



Glissando over strings between the tuning pins and whippen heel.



Strike tuning pin with beater; glissando over tuning pins.



Strike the struts laterally (never from above), with the sustain pedal depressed.



Plucked note (pizzicato).

Notational Study After Lachenmann



4

“gasping”

legno salt.
(firm pressure)

arco

mf *ff* *sfz* *fff* *f* *p* *f* *mp*

♩ = 65

flaut. 8va

p *ff*

p *ff* *f*

Ped.

10

“ethereal” 8va

p *mf* *p* *f* *mp*

frame

string *p* *mf*

“pont.”

pp

Ped.

[illegible]

16

flaut.

mf

fff

mp

cresc.

cresc.

fff

Ped.